

Champaign, Illinois, 61820

March 4, 2025

Hiring Manager

University of Alabama at Birmingham

Department of Psychiatry and Behavioral Neurobiology

Birmingham, AL 35205

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Data Scientist Assistant position at the University of Alabama at Birmingham. As a senior majoring in statistics with a minor in mathematics at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, I have developed strong skills in data analysis, predictive modeling, and statistical programming. I am eager to apply my expertise to support data-driven decision-making and program evaluations within the Substance Abuse Division.

My experience includes working extensively with R, Python, and SQL to conduct statistical analyses, visualize complex datasets, and develop automated data processing solutions. As an AI/ML intern team leader, I built machine learning models for predictive analytics, optimized data pipelines, and collaborated with multidisciplinary teams to translate findings into actionable insights. Additionally, my consulting experience at Illinois Business Consulting has strengthened my ability to extract data from multiple sources, conduct quality checks, and generate reports for internal and external stakeholders.

Beyond my coursework and research, I placed third in the 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge, where I applied advanced statistical modeling and geospatial analysis to assess public health impacts. This experience reinforced my ability to manage large datasets, perform hypothesis testing, and present findings in an accessible manner—aligning closely with the responsibilities of this role.

I am particularly drawn to this opportunity because of UAB's commitment to leveraging data science in behavioral health research. I welcome the opportunity to contribute my data analysis skills, statistical expertise, and problem-solving mindset to your team. Thank you for your time and consideration, and I look forward to the possibility of joining UAB.

Sincerely,

Sangjun Ko

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